



RELOCATION GUIDE

Sydney

Warrane

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Sydney.

The biggest system in the country. A harbour on the way to work.

Sydney is Australia's largest city and its largest health system: major teaching hospitals across several districts, specialist units that take referrals from all over the country, and a working harbour you can commute across by ferry. Around it sit a hundred beaches, free ocean pools and national parks on three sides. Plan your home and your commute well, and it is one of the most rewarding places in the world to build a clinical career.

~5.5M

people in Greater
Sydney

~100

beaches inside the
metro area

Largest

public health system in
Australia

1 hr

to the World Heritage
Blue Mountains

IN THIS GUIDE

01 Why clinicians choose Sydney

02 A city built around water

03 Healthcare and work in Sydney

04 Where to live in Sydney

05 Getting around Sydney

06 What it costs to live here

07 Sophie's insights

08 Food, shopping and the everyday

09 What people do at the weekend

10 Around Sydney

11 Families and schools

12 Local directory

13 Useful contacts

14 Your Ethicare journey

Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Sydney

Sydney needs little introduction. What it gives a working clinician is scale: more specialist services, more teaching and research, and more ways to shape a career than anywhere else in Australia, in a setting that still takes people's breath away years after they arrive.



If you're looking for a quiet life with a big house ten minutes from work, Sydney may not be it. But if you're drawn to the very top of your field, a harbour on your commute and a beach before your shift, Sydney could be a wonderful choice.

New South Wales runs the largest public health system in the country, and Sydney holds the deepest concentration of it: major teaching hospitals spread across several local health districts, quaternary services that take referrals from other states and from the Pacific, and research institutes working alongside the main campuses. For sub-specialty work, fellowships and academic pathways, the range of opportunity here is unmatched in Australia.

Then there is the city itself. Around five and a half million people live around a drowned river valley, which is why Sydney has dozens of centres rather than one, and why the water is never far away. Ferries are ordinary commuting on the same card as the trains, ocean pools are cut into the rocks along the coast, and a mild climate makes all of it usable most of the year.

Pay follows the NSW awards and enterprise agreements for each profession. We quote no figures in this guide and are always happy to walk you through the current agreement for your role.

WHAT YOU GAIN

The highest ceiling

More specialist and sub-specialist posts, more research and more teaching than anywhere else in the country. If your field is narrow, the density here is hard to match.

A spectacular everyday

A ferry across the harbour, a swim in an ocean pool, a coastal walk after a late finish. People really do live like this, year-round.

The world on your doorstep

Around four in ten Sydneysiders were born overseas, so whatever you grew up eating, celebrating or worshipping, there is a community here already.

GOOD TO KNOW

Housing shapes everything

Sydney is Australia's most expensive housing market. Choosing your district and suburb well is the key to enjoying the city, and we help with exactly that.

A big city to get across

The metro area is around seventy kilometres wide. Living near a train, metro or ferry line makes daily life far easier.

Sought-after roles

The biggest system attracts the most applicants. Start registration early and keep an open mind about districts, especially the fast-growing west.

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An honest word before you decide

Sydney is one of the most sought-after destinations in Australia, and competition for healthcare roles here is very high. Securing a role, and particularly a sponsored role, is considerably more challenging in Sydney than in regional Australia. We are not saying it's impossible, but we want to be honest with you: it can take longer, and it helps to be flexible. Many clinicians start in a regional city, where demand and sponsorship are often stronger, and move to Sydney later with Australian experience behind them.

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Weighing up your options?

People often compare Sydney with Melbourne, for similar depth of specialist work; Brisbane, for tertiary hospitals and more home for your salary; and regional New South Wales, for coastal living, shorter commutes and generous incentives. We are happy to talk any of them through.



Kayaking on the harbour, with the Opera House and the bridge behind: a very Sydney Saturday morning



An evening walk under the Harbour Bridge, which locals fondly call the Coathanger



Sydney Harbour at dusk: a view that never quite gets ordinary.

A city built around water

Sydney is less one city than four, divided by the harbour, the rivers and the national parks that press in from three sides. Knowing which Sydney you are moving to matters more here than anywhere else in Australia.

CBD TO THE OCEAN

The east

Surry Hills, Paddington, Randwick, Coogee and Bondi: terraces, ocean pools and the coastal walk, with several major teaching campuses close by.

ACROSS THE BRIDGE

The north shore

North Sydney, Chatswood and the leafy upper north shore, then the northern beaches up to Palm Beach. Family territory, big trees and well-regarded schools.

FOOD, TERRACES, TRAINS

The inner west

Newtown, Marrickville, Leichhardt and Balmain: Victorian housing, the city's liveliest food scene and good train and light rail links.

PARRAMATTA AND BEYOND

The greater west

Sydney's second CBD and the fast-growing western and south-western suburbs: big hospitals, family homes and a wonderfully multicultural everyday life.



The Queen Victoria Building in the city centre: Sydney's Victorian sandstone heritage sits alongside its glass towers



The Opera House forecourt, with the Harbour Bridge across Sydney Cove

Summer

DEC – FEB

Warm and humid, around 19–27°C on the coast and several degrees hotter in the west, with afternoon storms. Beach season, long evenings and outdoor everything.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Around 15–23°C, with warm sea, clear air and fewer crowds. Many locals' favourite time of year.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Mild and bright, around 9–18°C. A jacket is usually enough, the coastal walks stay busy, and Vivid lights up the harbour.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Around 14–23°C and warming up, with purple jacaranda blossom across the city in late October and November.

Good to know about the weather

- ✓ If you are looking west, choose a home that handles heat well: insulation, orientation and air conditioning matter much more twenty kilometres inland than at the beach.
- ✓ Daylight saving runs from October to April, which means long summer evenings on the harbour.
- ✓ In some summers bushfire smoke can drift across the city for a few days. If anyone in the family has asthma, it is worth having a plan.

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A note on Country

Sydney stands on the lands of the Gadigal and other clans of the Eora Nation. Warrane is the name for Sydney Cove, where the colony began, so this is where the colonial history of Australia starts. Acknowledgement of Country opens meetings, and health services work in partnership with Aboriginal community-controlled organisations. Your cultural induction is a valuable part of starting work here.

WORDS YOU'LL HEAR IN WEEK ONE

WHAT IT MEANS

Opal

The tap-on card for trains, metro, buses, ferries and light rail

The Coathanger

The Harbour Bridge, affectionately

Ocean pool

A free tidal saltwater pool cut into the rocks; there are dozens

Healthcare and work in Sydney

Registration is national, but hiring in Sydney happens district by district. Sydney holds the deepest concentration of clinical work in Australia, and the district you choose shapes your commute, your case mix and your colleagues for years.

New South Wales runs its public system through local health districts. Several of them cover metropolitan Sydney, broadly the city and east, the north, the inner and south-west, and the greater west. Each employs in its own right, runs its own recruitment and covers a defined area, with a principal referral hospital and a network of sites around it. Statewide specialty networks, including children's health and forensic mental health, sit alongside them and recruit separately.

Around the public districts sits the largest private hospital sector in the country, a substantial private imaging and pathology market, and major medical research institutes attached to the main teaching campuses. For radiographers, sonographers and allied health professionals especially, that means a wide choice of public, private and community roles.



Busy, complex work: Sydney's teaching hospitals carry the widest range of specialist services in Australia

THE OLDEST TEACHING CAMPUSES

The city and east

Long-established teaching hospitals and highly sought-after posts. A wonderful place to work, best approached with a role lined up and a clear housing plan.

ACROSS THE HARBOUR

The north

Large teaching hospitals, a settled catchment and a strong research presence. Check how the bridge commute fits your shifts.

BUSY AND DIVERSE

The inner and south-west

Major teaching hospitals with complex, varied work and steady recruitment. A great many of Sydney's best careers are built here.

WHERE THE GROWTH IS

The greater west

The fastest population growth in the state, sustained hospital investment and consistent recruitment, with family homes within easy reach. This is where we often suggest people look first.

Largest

public health system in Australia

with Sydney holding the deepest share of it

Several

metropolitan health districts

each hiring in its own right

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national register

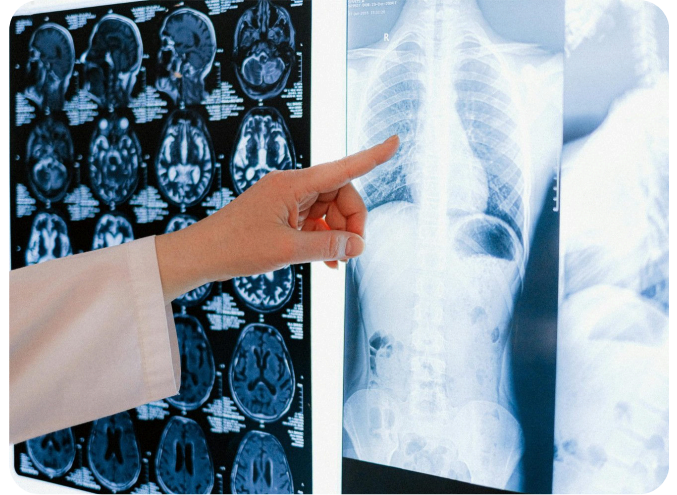
Ahpra registration works anywhere in Australia

If you want to work at the very top of a narrow field, Sydney has more of those posts than anywhere else in the country, and more people applying for them. Fellowships, research appointments and highly specialised units are all more plentiful here. The most useful advice we give is to look west as well as east: the western and south-western districts run large, busy teaching hospitals with real complexity, they are where the state is investing, and they recruit consistently.

One practical note: metropolitan Sydney is not classed as regional for skilled migration, so the visa options differ from much of regional New South Wales. We will talk you through what applies to your situation.



Patient-centred care is at the heart of every district



A large public and private imaging market means plenty of choice for radiographers and sonographers

Giving yourself the best chance in Sydney

- ✓ Be open to more than one campus, service or shift pattern. The wider your search, the better your chances.
- ✓ Keep a regional option alongside Sydney. Regional cities often have stronger demand and are more able to sponsor, and Australian experience makes a later move to Sydney much easier.
- ✓ Get your registration well under way early. Employers here often favour candidates who can start sooner.
- ✓ Talk to us early, so we can give you a realistic picture for your profession and specialty.

What to ask at interview

- ☐ Which district and which campus will I be based at, and might I be rostered across several sites?
- ☐ What does the roster look like: shift patterns, penalties, on-call frequency and how gaps are covered?
- ☐ How does salary packaging work here, and can I start it from day one?
- ☐ Is there any relocation support or help with accommodation?
- ☐ What CPD time and funding is available, and is conference travel supported?
- ☐ Is there research or teaching time, if that is part of why I am coming?
- ☐ What is staff parking like, and what is the commute at my actual shift times?
- ☐ What orientation, supervision and cultural induction is there for clinicians new to Australia?



Two things to do early

Start your Ahpra registration as soon as Sydney is on your shortlist, because paperwork is what moves start dates. And choose your district before you look at a single rental listing: in Sydney the campus sets the commute, and the commute shapes everything else.

Where to live in Sydney

In Sydney this is the big decision. The difference between an eastern-suburbs life and a western one, in cost, commute and weekends, is wider than in any other Australian city, so it pays to choose with your campus in mind.

~10–15 MIN · WALK TO WORK

Surry Hills & Darlinghurst

Terraces, restaurants and a genuine walk-to-work life next to the central hospital cluster. Lively, compact and in high demand.

~25–40 MIN · BEACHES

Randwick, Coogee & Bronte

Ocean pools and the coastal walk at the end of the street, with major campuses close by. Sharing a home is very normal here.

~15–25 MIN · FERRY

Cremorne, Neutral Bay & Mosman

Harbour views, ferry commutes and family life on the lower north shore. Possibly the best commute in the country.

~25–35 MIN · SCHOOLS

Chatswood & the upper north shore

Leafy, quieter and school-focused, with a large, long-established Chinese-Australian community and excellent food.

~15–25 MIN · INNER WEST

Newtown, Marrickville & Dulwich Hill

The best value inside ten kilometres: Victorian and Federation homes, great food and trains or light rail to the centre.

~30 MIN TO THE CBD · SPACE

Parramatta & the greater west

Sydney's second CBD, big hospitals, real family houses and some of the most multicultural suburbs in Australia, often thirty minutes from a large teaching hospital.

~45–75 MIN · SURF

The northern beaches

Manly to Palm Beach: beautiful, relaxed and family-friendly. There is no train, so it suits you best if your work is on the north side.



Looking across Lavender Bay from the lower north shore, where the ferry is part of the commute



A sunrise surf at Bondi before a day shift: everyday life in the eastern suburbs

The greater west deserves more attention than most guides give it. Around Parramatta, the western and south-western suburbs hold the fastest population growth in the state, the biggest hospital investment, and family houses at a fraction of coastal prices. Summers are a few degrees warmer and the beach becomes a weekend trip rather than a walk. If you're looking for a terrace by the sea, the west may not be it; if you're drawn to space, a garden and a short commute to a big teaching hospital, it could be a great choice, especially with children.

Renting in Sydney moves quickly. Go to inspections with every document ready to submit on the spot, and expect to apply for a few properties before one lands. That is normal here and not a reflection on you. Most newcomers rent for a year first and then choose again once they know the city.

Before you sign a lease

- ☐ What is the commute to your actual campus, door to door, at your actual shift times?
- ☐ Is there a train, metro, light rail or ferry stop within walking distance? Bus-only suburbs can feel much further out.
- ☐ If you are looking west, how does the home handle a 40-degree day? Check insulation, orientation and air conditioning.
- ☐ Is it in the school catchment you need? Check the exact address with the NSW school finder.
- ☐ Would a shorter first lease, or a house share, give you time to learn the city before committing?

Getting around Sydney

Sydney's public transport is better than visitors expect: an extensive train network, a driverless metro that keeps growing, light rail through the centre and ferries that are a genuine pleasure. The simple rule is to live near a station.



An ordinary weekday at Circular Quay station, with the Harbour Bridge behind the glass

ONE CARD FOR EVERYTHING

Opal

Tap on with an Opal card, or a contactless bank card or phone, across trains, metro, buses, ferries and light rail, with daily and weekly caps and cheaper off-peak travel.

THE BACKBONE

Trains

An extensive suburban network, plus intercity lines to the Blue Mountains, the Central Coast, Newcastle and Wollongong.

DRIVERLESS AND FREQUENT

Metro

Fast, frequent and expanding across the city, and already changing which suburbs count as well connected.

THE BEST COMMUTE IN AUSTRALIA

Ferries

Ordinary public transport on the same card, across the harbour and up the Parramatta River.

FROM THE CBD TO...	ROUGHLY	HOW
Surry Hills / Darlinghurst	10–15 min	Walk or light rail
Lower north shore	15–25 min	Ferry or train
Inner west	15–25 min	Train or light rail
The eastern beaches	25–40 min	Bus or light rail
Parramatta	~30 min	Train or river ferry
Northern beaches	45–75 min	Bus or car
Sydney Airport	~20 min	Train
Blue Mountains / Central Coast	~1 hr+	Intercity train or car



Double-deck trains run the suburban and intercity lines



Light rail along George Street, through the heart of the city

Driving in Sydney

- ✓ Australians drive on the left. Sydney's road network is shaped by the water, and peak-hour traffic is heavy, so public transport is often the quicker option.
- ✓ Inner-city hospital parking can be limited. Ask about staff parking at interview rather than assuming.
- ✓ Many motorways and harbour crossings are tolled electronically, so set up a toll account when you get a car.
- ✓ If you move to NSW from overseas, you need to switch to a NSW licence within six months. Holders of some licences, including UK, Irish and New Zealand ones, can usually swap without a test; check your country with Service NSW.

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The takeaway

Choose your home by its station, not its postcode. A well-connected suburb can give you back an hour a day compared with a bus-only one, and a car-free life is realistic near a train, metro or ferry line across much of the east, the inner west and the lower north shore.



Bondi Beach: around 25–40 minutes from the CBD by bus, or by train and bus

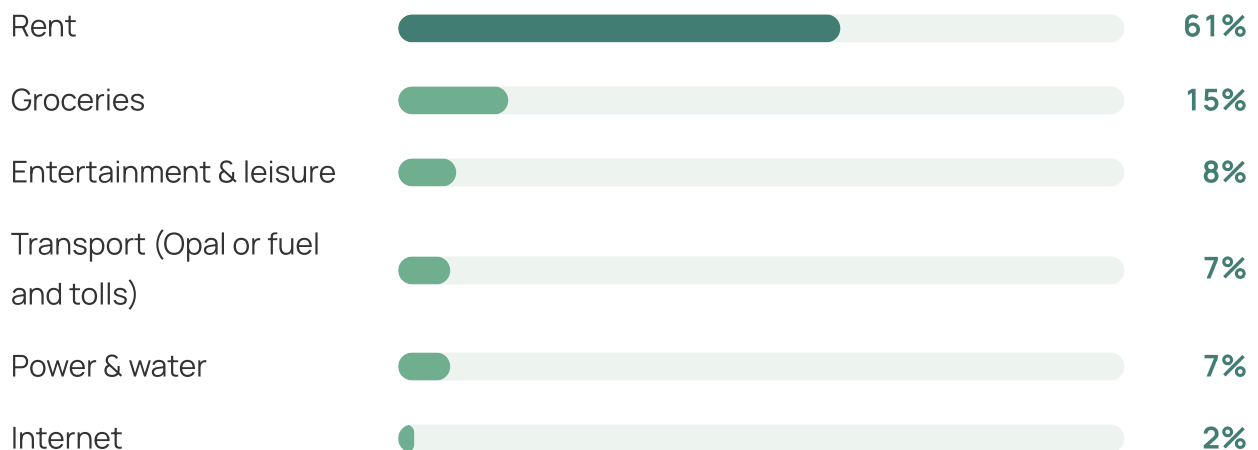
What it costs to live here

Sydney is Australia's most expensive city for housing, and the good news is that it rewards planning. Get the home and the commute right, and the rest of the city, much of it free, is yours to enjoy.

Your housing decision shapes your Sydney experience more than your salary does. The east-to-west difference is the biggest lever you have: a family house thirty minutes from a large teaching hospital in the west costs a fraction of a flat near an eastern campus.

Everyday costs such as groceries, transport and power are broadly similar to other Australian capitals. Rent is the line that varies, and so it is the one worth planning around. We do not print prices because they date quickly; use the live calculators in the directory to compare Sydney with the city you are leaving.

Where a month goes



Proportions for one person on a mid-range budget, not amounts. Rent is the largest share here of any city in our Australian collection, which is why where you live matters so much.

THE BIGGEST LEVER

Look west

The western and south-western suburbs offer far more home for your money, close to big, busy teaching hospitals.

VERY NORMAL HERE

Share for the first year

Sharing well into your thirties is common in Sydney, and it gives you a year to learn the city before choosing a suburb.

CAR-FREE CAN PAY

Live by the network

A home near a train, metro or ferry with no car at all can save more than a cheaper rent in a car-dependent suburb.

AT INTERVIEW

Ask about support

Some employers offer relocation help or accommodation support, particularly outside the inner city. It is always worth asking.



Bondi on a summer weekend: the best of Sydney is free, and shared with half the city

Where the money comes back

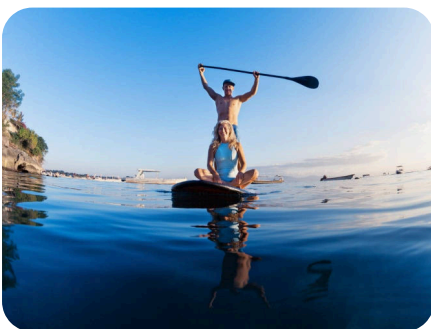
- ✓ The free city is world class: a hundred beaches, dozens of free ocean pools, coastal walks, harbour foreshore parks, botanic gardens and national parks on three sides.
- ✓ Public-health roles can salary-package part of your pay before tax. Ask payroll on day one, because in Sydney it makes a real difference.
- ✓ Free gas barbecues in parks and on the foreshore make a family day out very affordable.
- ✓ Good public transport makes a car optional in much of the inner city, a real saving over a year.

IN SHORT

- ✓ Plan your rent before you plan your suburb, and look at suburbs that fit both your budget and a comfortable commute.
- ✓ If the inner east feels out of reach, the inner west and the greater west offer wonderful lives close to big hospitals.
- ✓ Spend on location near transport, then enjoy the free city every weekend.



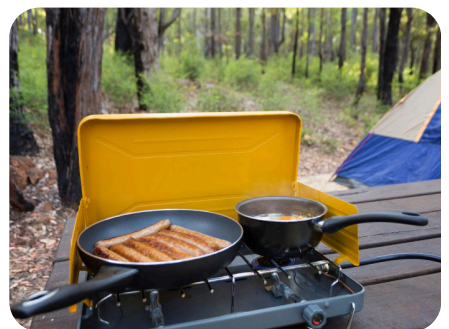
Dinner with friends at home: everyday costs here are much like other Australian capitals



Calm-water paddling costs nothing once you have a board



The waves are free, and surfing is for every age



Camping in a national park makes an affordable weekend away



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Sydney

Sydney is the city everyone names first, and for good reason. If your career needs the biggest system in the country, with the sub-specialty depth, the research links and the sheer scale, nowhere else in Australia offers quite as much. I love seeing clinicians take the ferry to work in their first week and realise this is their life now.

What I always say is: plan the home before the suburb. Choose your district, then look for a place near a station that fits your budget, and be open to the west, where so many wonderful careers are built. If what you want most is a big house and a ten-minute commute, I will happily show you Brisbane or Adelaide too. But if Sydney is calling, we will help you make it work, and you will have the harbour, the beaches and the mountains waiting every weekend.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing

Food, shopping and the everyday

Sydney's best food is in the suburbs where people actually live: the Vietnamese south-west, the Lebanese west, the Chinese north shore and the Greek and Italian inner west. Eating your way around them is the quickest way to understand the city.



Lunch under the umbrellas at Circular Quay, a short walk from the ferries

SOUTH-WEST · VIETNAMESE

Cabramatta

One of the great Vietnamese food precincts anywhere outside Vietnam, with markets and bakeries to match.

WEST · LEBANESE, TURKISH, AFGHAN

Lakemba & Auburn

Superb Middle Eastern cooking, halal butchers and grocers, and late-night markets during Ramadan.

PARRAMATTA · LITTLE INDIA

Harris Park

Sydney's Little India: South Asian restaurants, sweet shops and grocers, and a big Diwali celebration.

NORTH · CHINESE, KOREAN, JAPANESE

Chatswood & Eastwood

Outstanding East Asian food and supermarkets on the north shore.

INNER WEST

Marrickville & Leichhardt

Greek, Italian, Vietnamese and Portuguese food layered along a few lively kilometres.

A SYDNEY RITUAL

Brunch and coffee

Weekend brunch is a social institution here. Find your local café in week one; the best ones have a queue.

For everyday shopping you will find Woolworths and Coles everywhere, ALDI for a great-value basket, and excellent independent grocers and butchers in every neighbourhood above. The markets are a weekend pleasure: Carriageworks on a Saturday for keen cooks, Marrickville for value and variety, Paddy's Markets for fresh produce, and the striking new Sydney Fish Market on Blackwattle Bay, which opened in January 2026.

With around four in ten residents born overseas, Sydney is the easiest Australian city in which to find whatever you grew up eating: halal butchers across the west and south-west, kosher shops and bakeries in the eastern suburbs, South Asian groceries in Harris Park and Wentworthville, African and Middle Eastern stores across the west, and Asian supermarkets almost everywhere. Those shops sit alongside the associations, places of worship and weekend gatherings that turn a new city into home.

The rhythm of the week

- ✓ Sydney lives outdoors and early: swims before work, coastal walks at dawn, Saturday parkrun and outdoor tables most of the year.
- ✓ Summer brings the beach, outdoor cinemas and long evenings; winter barely closes anything, and the Vivid light festival fills the harbour each May and June.
- ✓ New Year's Eve fireworks on the harbour are worth doing at least once, from a park with a picnic.
- ✓ Sport fills the weekends, from rugby league and AFL to cricket, netball and football, and joining a club is one of the fastest ways to meet people.



Fresh seafood at Sydney Fish Market, a weekend favourite



A busy Sydney food market on a weekend morning



The flat white: find your local café in your first week



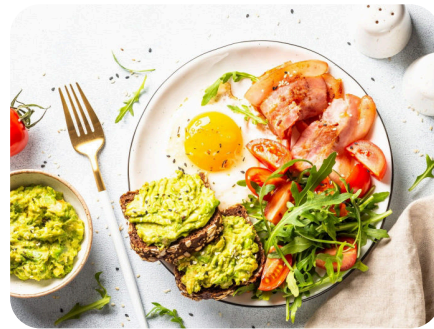
St Mary's Cathedral, the seat of Sydney's Catholic archdiocese; faith communities of every tradition are a warm way in



A statue of Lord Shiva at a Hindu temple in Minto, in Sydney's south-west



Weekend brunch: a Sydney social ritual



Smashed avocado on toast, a café classic



Asian food of every kind is easy to find across the city



South Asian cooking and groceries are close at hand in Harris Park and beyond



Japanese food, from city basements to suburban sushi bars

What people do at the weekend

Sydney's weekends are extraordinary: a hundred beaches, a harbour you can swim in, national parks on three sides and a World Heritage escarpment an hour from the suburbs. Most of it is free.

East, Bondi, Tamarama, Bronte and Coogee are linked by the coastal walk that locals do at least once a month, with ocean pools cut into the rocks along the way. North, Manly, Freshwater, Curl Curl and the peninsula up to Palm Beach are quieter and great for surfing. South, Cronulla and the beaches inside the Royal National Park thin the crowds out completely.

The ocean pools deserve their own mention: dozens of them, tidal, free and used year-round by people of every age. They are among the most welcoming things about the city.

EASTERN SUBURBS · 2-3 HRS

Bondi to Coogee

The classic clifftop walk, with a swim at each ocean pool and coffee at the end.

~30 MIN FROM CIRCULAR QUAY

The Manly ferry

It costs the same as a bus and is one of the great urban journeys anywhere. Walk back around the harbour on the Manly to Spit track.

BALMORAL · NIELSEN PARK

Harbour beaches

Flat, calm water that is perfect for children and paddleboards.

BY FERRY

Cockatoo Island

Convict and shipbuilding history in the middle of the harbour, with camping and glamping.

~45 MIN NORTH

Ku-ring-gai Chase

Bushland running down to the water, and Aboriginal rock engravings to discover with care and respect.

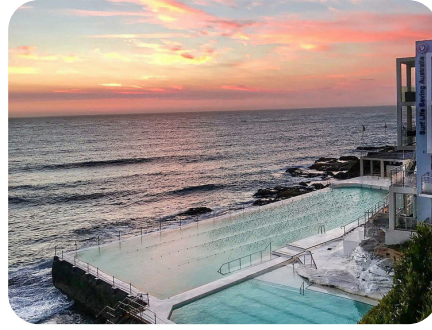
MAY - JUNE

Vivid Sydney

The harbour and city buildings light up for the winter light festival; walk the foreshore after dark.



The ocean pool at Bondi: free, tidal and swum year-round



Dusk at the Bondi ocean pool, the end of a perfect summer day



Learning to surf: Sydney's beaches run nippers and surf lessons for children

Ten weekends to start with

- ☐ The Bondi to Coogee coastal walk, with a swim at each ocean pool
- ☐ The Manly ferry, then the Manly to Spit walk back around the harbour
- ☐ The Blue Mountains: the Three Sisters, then a walk away from the lookouts
- ☐ The Royal National Park coast track, or the beaches you walk into
- ☐ Ku-ring-gai Chase for the rock engravings and the water views
- ☐ A Hunter Valley weekend of cellar doors and a long lunch
- ☐ The Sea Cliff Bridge and the south coast
- ☐ Cockatoo Island and the harbour's history
- ☐ Balmoral or Nielsen Park for calm harbour swimming
- ☐ Vivid in winter, walking the harbour foreshore after dark



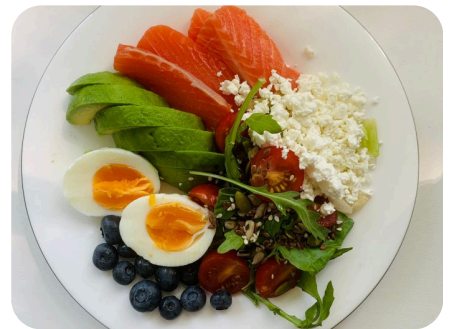
Sydney's beaches have surf schools for every level, and plenty of women's surf groups



Koalas in the gum trees



A long lunch among the vines



Weekend brunch

Around Sydney

Three ways out of the city, and something remarkable at the end of each: the Blue Mountains to the west, the wine country and beaches to the north, and a spectacular coast road to the south.



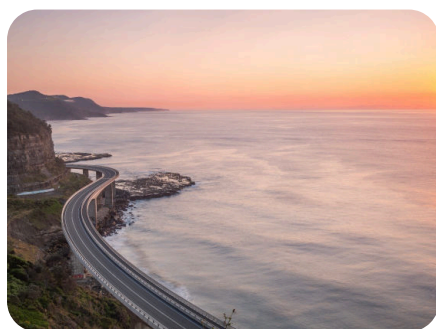
The Blue Mountains, a World Heritage escarpment that begins about an hour west of the city

The Blue Mountains begin an hour west: sandstone cliffs, canyons, waterfalls and hundreds of kilometres of walking track, with mountain villages around Katoomba and Leura that are noticeably cooler than the city in summer. You can reach them on the intercity train, which makes a car-free day trip easy.

South, the Royal National Park, the second oldest in the world, has the coast track and beaches you walk into. Beyond it the Grand Pacific Drive crosses the Sea Cliff Bridge and runs down the Illawarra coast to Wollongong, and further on to the white sand of Jervis Bay. North, the Central Coast offers beaches, lakes and a slower pace, then Newcastle, Port Stephens and the Hunter Valley, Australia’s oldest wine region and the classic Sydney weekend away.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Bondi, Manly & the city beaches	20–40 min	The nearest beaches: surf, ocean pools and coastal walks, within easy reach of most of the city. Swim between the red and yellow flags.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Snowy Mountains ski fields (Perisher & Thredbo)	~6 hrs by car	Australia's biggest ski fields, with a season of roughly June to early October. A classic winter road trip or long weekend.
Wollongong	~1 hr 20	The nearest other city: beaches, a harbour and lighthouse, and the escarpment behind.
Sydney Airport	~20 min by train	Australia's busiest international gateway. Western Sydney International Airport opens to passengers in late October 2026.
Blue Mountains	~1–2 hrs	The Three Sisters, canyons, waterfalls and cosy mountain villages; easy by intercity train.
Royal National Park & the Sea Cliff Bridge	~1 hr	Coast walks, hidden beaches and the famous bridge curving around the cliffs.
Hunter Valley	~2 hrs	Australia's oldest wine region: cellar doors, long lunches and hot-air balloon flights.
Newcastle & Port Stephens	~2–2 hrs 30	A relaxed coastal city with ocean baths, then dolphins, dunes and calm bays.
Canberra	~3 hrs	The national capital: galleries, museums and Parliament House.



The Sea Cliff Bridge on the coast road south, about an hour from the city



The Illawarra coast north of Wollongong, seen from above



The harbour and lighthouse in Wollongong, the nearest city to the south

~1 HR+ NORTH

The Central Coast

Beaches, lakes and national parks, popular for a weekend shack, and an easy intercity train ride.

~2 HRS NORTH

Newcastle

A friendly coastal city with historic ocean baths, Nobbys Head and a great café scene.

~2 HRS 30

Port Stephens

Dolphin cruises, sand dunes for sandboarding and sheltered bays that children love.

~2 HRS

Hunter Valley

Cellar doors, cheese, chocolate and gardens: a lovely weekend away for two, or with friends.

~3 HRS SOUTH

Jervis Bay

Famously white sand, clear water and the quiet coastal towns of the south coast.

~6 HRS BY CAR

The Snowy Mountains

Ski and snowboard in winter, and alpine walks to the top of Mount Kosciuszko in summer.



Newcastle's ocean baths and the city beyond, about two hours north



A summer's day at Nobbys Beach in Newcastle



Newcastle's Customs House, near the harbour



Nobbys Head at sunset, Newcastle



Broulee on the NSW South Coast



The Tweed coast in the far north of the state



A coastal town on the NSW South Coast



Canola fields in country NSW

Families and schools

Sydney is a wonderful place to grow up: beaches and bush, sport on every weekend, free festivals and a huge choice of schools. A little planning around catchments and visas makes the move smooth.



Senior school: clear pathways to university and vocational training



Beach days are an easy, free family outing

Schooling in New South Wales has three sectors. Government (public) schools educate most children and include selective high schools and opportunity classes for academically gifted students. Catholic systemic schools, run by the dioceses of Sydney, Parramatta and Broken Bay, are often more affordable than families expect. Independent schools range from small community and faith schools to large, long-established colleges.

Children start in Kindergarten, the first year of primary school, usually in the year they turn five (they can start if they turn five by 31 July, and must be at school by six). Primary runs from Kindergarten to Year 6 and high school from Year 7 to Year 12, ending with the Higher School Certificate (HSC). The school year has four terms, starting in late January or early February.

School fees on a temporary visa

- ✓ In Greater Sydney, dependants of most temporary visa holders, including many on employer-sponsored visas, pay a temporary resident tuition fee to attend a NSW government school.
- ✓ Check the current position for your visa subclass with the NSW Department of Education's Temporary Residents Program (DE International) before you weigh an offer, and we will help you work it through.
- ✓ Some exemptions apply, including for certain visa holders whose children attend regional schools and for low-income families, and the rules can change from year to year.
- ✓ Permanent residents and citizens attend government schools on the same basis as local families.

Choosing a school

- ☐ Check the catchment at the exact address with the NSW school finder before you sign a lease. Local public schools must take children who live in their catchment.
- ☐ Popular schools in high-demand areas fill quickly, so research schools and homes together.
- ☐ Catholic and independent schools set their own fees and many have waiting lists, so enquire early.
- ☐ Ask about English as an Additional Language or Dialect (EAL/D) support if your child is still learning English.

What children tend to love here

- ✓ Nippers at the local surf club, learning beach safety and surf skills on summer Sunday mornings.
- ✓ Taronga Zoo, reached by ferry, and the Australian Museum and Powerhouse for rainy days.
- ✓ Free school-holiday programs at local libraries and councils.
- ✓ Ocean pools and calm harbour beaches such as Balmoral and Nielsen Park.
- ✓ Weekend sport for every age: football, netball, cricket, rugby league, Little Athletics and swimming.

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Early childhood

Children can attend long day care, family day care or a community preschool before school. The Australian Government's Child Care Subsidy helps with the cost for eligible families, and the NSW Government's Start Strong program funds fee relief for preschool in the year or two before school. Popular centres have waiting lists, so register early.

WORLD-CLASS AND CLOSE BY

Universities

The University of Sydney, UNSW, Macquarie University, UTS and Western Sydney University, alongside ACU and Notre Dame, all teaching health and medical programs.

VOCATIONAL STUDY

TAFE NSW

Practical courses and qualifications across the city, and free English classes for eligible migrants through the Adult Migrant English Program.



After the bell: school days here end around 3pm, with sport and activities to follow

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Sydney rewards the people who plan for it, and gives back a harbour, a hundred beaches and the career of a lifetime.

Your Sydney address book

Around four in ten Sydneysiders were born overseas, so almost every community has an established home here: a Malayalee association more than four decades old, Syro-Malabar and Indian Orthodox parishes in the west, a peak Filipino council with dozens of member groups, and long-standing Sri Lankan, Zimbabwean and Irish networks. Multicultural NSW, the Ethnic Communities' Council and settlement services such as SSI are good first stops for newcomers.

COUNCILS & LOCAL SERVICES

City of Sydney

The council for the CBD and inner suburbs: libraries, pools, parks, events and waste collection

02 9265 9333 cityofsydney.nsw.gov.au

City of Parramatta

The council for Sydney's second CBD and surrounding suburbs in the west

cityofparramatta.nsw.gov.au

Service NSW

Licences, car registration, the Savings Finder and many NSW Government services in one place

13 77 88 service.nsw.gov.au

Transport for NSW trip planner

Timetables, the trip planner, Opal card information and travel alerts

transportnsw.info

healthdirect

Free 24-hour health advice from a registered nurse; call 000 in an emergency

1800 022 222 healthdirect.gov.au

NSW Fair Trading

Renting rights, rental bonds and consumer advice

13 32 20 fairtrading.nsw.gov.au

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Sydney Malayalee Association (SydMal)

Sydney's long-established Malayali association: Onam, Christmas and national days, a seniors' forum, a women's forum and family events.

facebook.com/execom.sydmal

Federation of Indian Associations of NSW

Umbrella body for Indian community associations across NSW.

Philippine Community Council of NSW

The peak body for the Filipino community in NSW, with more than 50 member associations; runs the Philippine Christmas Festival in Darling Harbour.

Sri Lanka Association of NSW

Cultural and social association for Sri Lankan Australians in Sydney, with events through the year.

slansw.org.au

Zimbabwe Association in Australia, NSW (ZIMAA NSW)

Community association for Zimbabwean Australians in NSW, celebrating Zimbabwean culture with events including an annual gala dinner.

Irish Support Agency

Free support for the Irish community in NSW: housing, wellbeing, employment, family and legal help. Based in Surry Hills.

1800 186 966 irishsupportagency.org.au

Multicultural NSW

The NSW Government agency for multicultural communities, with information on services, interpreting and community events.

multicultural.nsw.gov.au

Ethnic Communities' Council of NSW

The peak body for culturally and linguistically diverse communities in NSW since 1975.

eccnsw.org.au

Settlement Services International (SSI)

Settlement support, community programs and employment pathways for migrants across NSW.

ssi.org.au

Adult Migrant English Program at TAFE NSW

Free English classes for eligible migrants, funded by the Australian Government, with childcare available while you study.

1800 114 707 tafensw.edu.au/amep

PLACES OF WORSHIP

St Mary's Cathedral

Sydney's Catholic cathedral, beside Hyde Park, with parishes across every suburb.

stmaryscathedral.org.au

St Alphonsa Syro-Malabar Catholic Forane Parish, Blacktown

Syro-Malabar parish for Malayalee Catholics in western Sydney; further Syro-Malabar communities meet across Sydney.

syromalabarparramatta.org

Syro-Malabar Eparchy of St Thomas the Apostle

The Syro-Malabar diocese for Australia, listing parishes and missions across Sydney, including Blacktown, Campbelltown, Penrith, Holsworthy and the north shore.

syromalabar.org.au

St Thomas Indian Orthodox Cathedral, Wattle Grove

Malankara Orthodox cathedral in south-west Sydney, with Sunday school and youth and women's groups.

stthomasorthodoxcathedral.org.au

St Andrew's Cathedral

Sydney's Anglican cathedral on George Street, with services and music through the week.

02 9265 1661 sydneycathedral.com

Hillsong Church

Large Pentecostal church with campuses across Sydney.

hillsong.com

Greek Orthodox Archdiocese of Australia

Headquartered in Redfern, with Greek Orthodox parishes across Sydney.

greekorthodox.org.au

Lakemba Mosque (Lebanese Muslim Association)

One of Australia's largest mosques, run by Australia's oldest Islamic not-for-profit. 71-75 Wangee Road, Lakemba.

02 9750 6833 lma.org.au

Auburn Gallipoli Mosque

An Ottoman-style mosque in Auburn welcoming thousands of worshippers each week.

gallipolimosque.org.au

Sri Venkateswara Temple, Helensburgh

One of the best-known Hindu temples in the southern hemisphere, on the southern edge of Sydney. 1 Temple Road, Helensburgh.

svtsydney.org

Gurdwara Sahib Glenwood

One of Sydney's largest Sikh gurdwaras, run by the Guru Nanak Foundation, in the north-west.

Nan Tien Temple

The largest Buddhist temple in the southern hemisphere, a branch of Fo Guang Shan, at Berkeley near Wollongong; about an hour and a quarter south.

nantien.org.au

The Great Synagogue

Sydney's historic synagogue, established in 1878, facing Hyde Park. 166 Castlereagh Street.

greatsynagogue.org.au

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Harris Park (Little India)

Wigram, Marion and Station Streets near Parramatta: South Asian grocers, sweet shops and restaurants.

Haldon Street, Lakemba

Halal butchers, Middle Eastern grocers and bakeries, and night markets during Ramadan.

Cabramatta

Vietnamese and South-East Asian grocers, fresh produce and bakeries in the south-west.

Tong Li Supermarket

Asian supermarket with stores in Sydney, including Burwood.

Hadassa Kosher Butchery

Kosher butcher serving the Jewish community of the eastern suburbs.

Glicks

Long-standing kosher bakery known for its bagels, in the eastern suburbs.

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

Woolworths

National supermarket chain with stores across Sydney and online delivery.

[woolworths.com.au](https://www.woolworths.com.au)

Coles

National supermarket chain with stores across Sydney and online delivery.

[coles.com.au](https://www.coles.com.au)

ALDI

Discount supermarket, good for a great-value weekly shop.

[aldi.com.au](https://www.aldi.com.au)

Sydney Fish Market

Australia's largest seafood market, in its new building on Blackwattle Bay since January 2026.

[sydneyfishmarket.com.au](https://www.sydneyfishmarket.com.au)

Paddy's Markets

Fresh produce and general markets at Haymarket in the city and at Flemington in the west.

paddysmarkets.com.au

Carriageworks Farmers Market

Popular Saturday farmers' market at Carriageworks, Eveleigh, near Redfern.

carriageworks.com.au

Marrickville markets

Sunday organic food and farmers' market at the Addison Road Community Centre in the inner west.

SCHOOLS & UNIFORMS

NSW school finder

Find your local public school and check the catchment for an exact address.

education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder

Temporary Residents Program (DE International)

The NSW Department of Education's rules, fees and exemptions for children of temporary visa holders attending government schools.

deinternational.nsw.edu.au

Sydney Catholic Schools

Around 147 Catholic primary and secondary schools across the Archdiocese of Sydney.

sydcatholicschools.nsw.edu.au

Independent Schools NSW

The association representing independent schools across NSW, with a guide to its member schools.

isnsw.edu.au

School uniform shops

Most NSW schools sell uniforms through their own uniform shop (often run by the P&C) or a nominated supplier; the school website lists where to buy, and many run second-hand sales.

HOUSING & AREAS

realestate.com.au

Australia's largest property site for rentals and sales.

[realestate.com.au](https://www.realestate.com.au)

Domain

Rental and sales listings, with suburb profiles.

[domain.com.au](https://www.domain.com.au)

Flatmates.com.au

Australia's biggest share accommodation site, useful for a first year in a share house.

[flatmates.com.au](https://www.flatmates.com.au)

Rental Bonds Online (NSW Fair Trading)

NSW Fair Trading holds rental bonds; lodge, view and claim your bond online.

nsw.gov.au/housing-and-construction/renting-a-place-to-live/residential-rental-bonds

Tenants' Union of NSW

Free renting factsheets and links to local Tenants Advice and Advocacy Services across Sydney.

tenants.org.au

GETTING AROUND

Transport for NSW (transportnsw.info)

Trip planner, timetables, Opal information and travel alerts for trains, metro, buses, ferries and light rail.

[transportnsw.info](https://www.transportnsw.info)

Opal

Manage your Opal card, top-ups and travel history; contactless bank cards also work.

[opal.com.au](https://www.opal.com.au)

Service NSW

Convert your overseas driver licence (within six months of moving to NSW), register a car and more.

13 77 88 [service.nsw.gov.au](https://www.service.nsw.gov.au)

Linkt

Toll account for Sydney's motorways and harbour crossings.

[linkt.com.au](https://www.linkt.com.au)

COST COMPARISON LINKS

Numbeo: cost of living in Sydney

Crowd-sourced prices to compare Sydney with the city you are leaving; treat it as a ballpark.

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Sydney

NSW Government payments and assistance

NSW concessions, rebates and cost-of-living support, including the Savings Finder.

nsw.gov.au/money-and-taxes/concessions-and-rebates



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in Australia you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time
000

Emergency from a mobile

Also connects to emergency services from any mobile phone
112

healthdirect

Free 24/7 health advice from a registered nurse
1800 022 222 [healthdirect.gov.au](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au)

Lifeline

24/7 crisis support and suicide prevention, by phone, text or chat
13 11 14 [lifeline.org.au](https://www.lifeline.org.au)

Poisons Information Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned
13 11 26

Pregnancy, Birth and Baby

Free support for parents from pregnancy to preschool
1800 882 436 [pregnancybirthbaby.org.au](https://www.pregnancybirthbaby.org.au)

Private health insurance complaints

The Commonwealth Ombudsman's free complaints service
1300 737 299 [ombudsman.gov.au](https://www.ombudsman.gov.au)

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Department of Home Affairs

Visas, skilled occupation lists and processing times
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au

ImmiAccount

Lodge and track your visa application online
online.immi.gov.au

Register of migration agents (OMARA)

Check an agent is registered before you pay
mara.gov.au

Ahpra

National registration and the National Boards
1300 419 495 [ahpra.gov.au](https://www.ahpra.gov.au)

Fair Work Ombudsman

Awards, pay rates and your rights at work
13 13 94 [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au)

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Medicare · Services Australia

Enrolment, cards, claims and reciprocal health care agreements
132 011 [servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare](https://www.servicesaustralia.gov.au/medicare)

healthdirect service finder

Find a GP, pharmacy, urgent care or hospital near you
[healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services](https://www.healthdirect.gov.au/australian-health-services)

privatehealth.gov.au

Compare private health cover independently; run by the Commonwealth Ombudsman
[privatehealth.gov.au](https://www.privatehealth.gov.au)

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

NSW school finder

Government schools and catchments in New South Wales
[education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder](https://www.education.nsw.gov.au/school-finder)

Find my school (Victoria)

School zones for any Victorian address
[findmyschool.vic.gov.au](https://www.findmyschool.vic.gov.au)

Find a school (Queensland)

State schools and catchment areas
qld.gov.au/education/schools/find

Find a public school (WA)

Western Australian public schools and local-intake areas
wa.gov.au/service/education-and-training/school-education/find-public-school

School zones (South Australia)

Zone maps for government schools
education.sa.gov.au/parents-and-families/enrol-school-or-preschool/zones-catchments-and-capacity-management/maps-school-zones-enrolment-year

Find your local school (Tasmania)

Intake areas for Tasmanian government schools
decyp.tas.gov.au/learning/find-your-local-school

Priority enrolment areas (ACT)

Find a Canberra public school for your address
act.gov.au/education-and-training/find-a-school-and-enrol

Choose a school (NT)

Urban and remote schools in the Northern Territory
nt.gov.au/learning/primary-and-secondary-students/choose-a-school

Starting Blocks

Compare childcare services and quality ratings near you
startingblocks.gov.au

Child Care Subsidy

Eligibility, rates and how to apply
servicesaustralia.gov.au/child-care-subsidy

MONEY & HOME

Australian Taxation Office

Apply for your tax file number (TFN), tax and super
13 28 61 ato.gov.au

Moneysmart

Free, independent budgeting, super and banking tools
moneysmart.gov.au

SETTLING IN

TIS National

Free interpreting by phone, 24/7, in 150+ languages
131 450 tisnational.gov.au

Settle in Australia

Home Affairs' settlement topics and services for new arrivals
immi.homeaffairs.gov.au/settling-in-australia

MyAus app

Government app to help newcomers find services, in many languages
myausapp.com

Overseas drivers (Austroads)

How overseas licences are recognised, with links to each state's licensing authority
austroads.gov.au/drivers-and-vehicles/overseas-drivers/country-recognition



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not registered migration agents.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to Ahpra registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

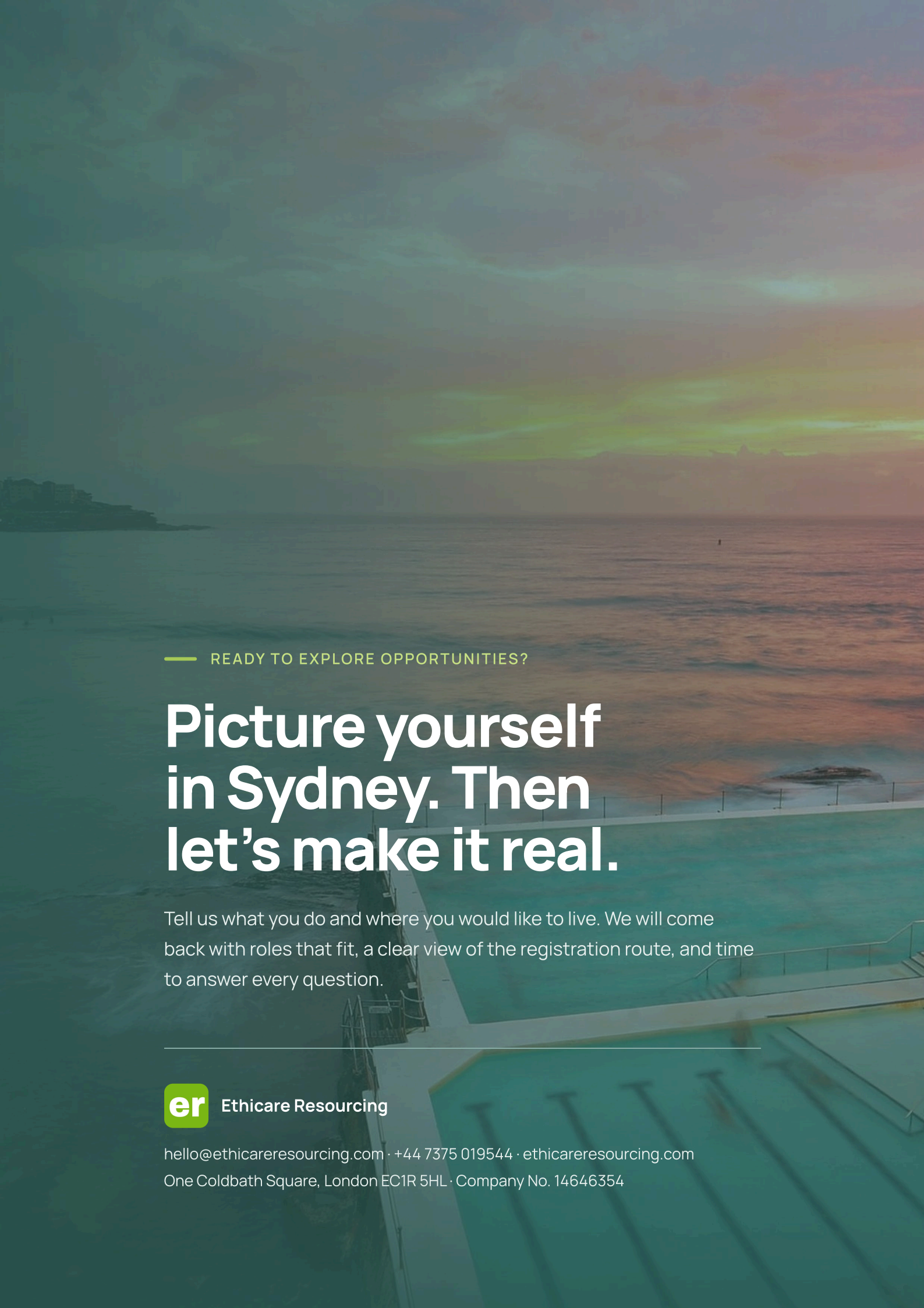
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Sydney. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, a clear view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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